

RARE BIRD REPORT--SIGHT RECORD

REPORT FILED BY: Alan E. Versaw
403 Maplewood Drive
Colorado Springs, CO 80907
(719)266-5065

7-0 (A)

Red 5/7/00 vpl

SPECIES: White-winged Dove (*Zenaida asiatica*)

DATE(S): May 6, 2000

OF BIRDS SEEN: 1 SEX: Undetermined PLUMAGE: Adult

LATILONG: 19 ELEVATION: 6050 ft

TIME OF DAY: 0630 LOCALITY: backyard, address above

NEAREST TOWN: Colorado Springs (within city limits) COUNTY: El Paso

DURATION OF OBSERVATION: 5 minutes

OTHER OBSERVERS: Ruth Ann Versaw

LIGHT CONDITIONS: reasonably bright overcast conditions

OPTICAL EQUIPMENT: Bushnell 8 X 42 Natureviews

DISTANCE: As close as about 10 feet

PHOTO DATA: none, bird flew about same time that I was getting the camera focused (I was well hidden and do not believe that I flushed the bird).

BIRD BEHAVIOR: The bird flew into a lilac bush in my backyard. From there it dropped to the ground and foraged for a while in the spill beneath of one my feeders. Common Grackles came in and the bird retreated back to cover. Eventually, the bird wandered beneath my other feeder closer to the house. It stayed here for some time before flying off, apparently of its own accord.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF BIRD: The skin around the eye was distinctly bluish. The eye had a red iris surrounding the pupil. Pink feet. Lower edge of folded wing whitish. The folded tail was only slightly rounded on the end with white on the corners. The central tail feathers had a distinctly rufous color, something like the tail of a Hermit Thrush. The outer tail feathers were grayish-brown above the lighter-colored tips. When the bird flew, the tail was not at all pointed like a Mourning Dove. A prominent white flash appeared in the wings roughly perpendicular to the leading edge of the wing. In flight, the wingtips were darker than the portion of the wing closer to the body. Folded wings were uniformly brownish-gray (except the whitish lower edge) without any distinctive marks. Can't say anything for certain about the wingtips of the folded wing—I did not note this mark. The bird had a distinct dark mark on the lower side of the face, much like the mark of a Mourning Dove though, somehow, it seemed a bit more prominent than on the MODO (this is, at best, a "soft" character).

SONG AND/OR CALL: No vocalizations made during the time I watched the bird.

HABITAT DESCRIPTION: A fairly typical backyard with grass and a tree and a few bushes. What may not be so normal is a lot of small rock in the backyard—covering about 1/3 of the total area. The bird stayed always either on the rock or in a lilac bush during its entire stay. When the bird flew, it flew first to a large tree in a neighbor's yard.

ELIMINATION OF SIMILAR SPECIES: Mourning Dove has (at least most often) dark spots on top of the folded wings, only a faint hint of blue skin around the eye, no red iris, and, of course, no prominent white flashes in wings (or whitish edge to folded wings). This last-mentioned mark is the one I consider most clearly determinative—although the blue skin and iris are certainly distinctive. Size was about right for a MODO. Also, the MODO has a distinctly pointed tail, with a very different configuration of white along the edges. Eurasian Colored-Dove has no blue around the eye, has a prominent dark collar (this bird had none), and has no white flashes or edges in wing. Also, the tail of the EUCD does not have the rufous coloration and the bird is paler overall.

PRIOR EXPERIENCE WITH THIS AND SIMILAR BIRDS: I have seen all three species mentioned above. The Mourning Dove is quite familiar to me, of course, but the other two are much less so. I almost immediately recognized this bird could not be a Mourning Dove. My first guess was WWDO, but it has been long enough since I've seen one that I did want to go to my field guides to confirm my suspicions.

REFERENCES CONSULTED: National Geo guide, 3rd edition and 2nd edition (the 3rd edition is much more useful for this bird). Also, Peterson Western 3rd edition (better than NG 2nd, but not as good as NG 3rd).

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SIGNATURE: